



TikTok rival by Facebook

Facebook is reportedly working on its own form of video music app called Lasso that is set to rival TikTok. <https://digit.in/nov-18-33-1>



Tesla to enter Chinese market

Reporting its first quarterly profits in two years, Tesla is looking forward to expand manufacturing in China. <https://digit.in/nov-18-33-2>

ROG Zephyrus M (GM501)

Slim and power-packed

When ASUS launched the GX501 Zephyrus last year at COMPUTEX 2017, it was the first MAX-Q laptop to be announced and it was a pretty decent device for that reason. What kind of changes did ASUS do to the Zephyrus M GM501? Let's take a peek inside and find out.

Chassis build

The Zephyrus M comes across as an extremely thin device featuring the same hatch design. The hatch in question, has been made more durable with a wider opening. The rear side of the panel retains the brushed metal finish with a distinct line that parts the surface diagonally. The ROG logo has a backlight and is not an over-the-top implementation.

On the inside, the design is fairly standard. This is a thicker notebook, so ASUS didn't have to slim down the components and spread them across the entire area. The battery takes up a smaller footprint but due to the added thickness, is of a higher capacity.

Display

The ASUS ROG GM501 sports a 15.6-inch FHD AHVA panel made by AUOptronics. It has a nice anti-glare coating and decent viewing angles as well. There's a 144 Hz panel with support for NVIDIA G-Sync as well. It's brighter, has support for a wider colour gamut and the response time is 9ms (Tr+Td).

Performance

Most gaming laptops that we've seen in this price segment couple the hexa-core Intel Core i7-8750H with a GTX 1070. However, the single-channel memory might cause some of the numbers to be lower than competing



Price
₹1,99,990



PERFORMANCE.....	77
FEATURES.....	86
BUILD.....	85

gaming laptops. To showcase the performance difference brought on by the single channel setup, we ran a memory benchmark to get read speeds of 19346 MB/s and write speeds of 19838 MBps. If ASUS had used 2 DIMMs instead of one,

these numbers would have been in the vicinity of 37-41,000 MBps. While real world performance doesn't scale in the same manner, you can expect a difference of about 11-17% in performance.

In games, we managed to get about 90 FPS in Far Cry 5, 112 in Witcher 3, 90 in Rise of the Tomb Raider and about 90-95 in PUBG. Some older games would scale well into the high 130s. Given the 144Hz panel on the Zephyrus M, it's a visual treat to enjoy fluid gameplay at high frame rates.

We also conducted Wi-Fi benchmarks on the laptop. The upstream numbers featured in the higher 600s (Mbps) and the lower 600s for the downstream numbers. It doesn't feature a separate QoS solution to prioritise traffic, but you can always install one yourself and get the job done. That decision is up to you and depends on your specific requirements.

Verdict

The ASUS ROG Zephyrus M GM501 follows in the footsteps of the GX501. While the older model was priced at a premium owing to its extreme slimness and hardware portfolio, the GM501 isn't the same. There's competition from other brands in this segment and it's hard to overlook ASUS's decision to ship a single RAM module in the Zephyrus M. Most users will not notice the difference in performance, however, when you're catering to the enthusiast gamer, these things do matter. There are two variants of the Zephyrus M GM501, the GTX 1060 based GM501GM (₹1,59,990) and the GTX 1070 based GM501GS (₹1,99,990). When you compare the MSI GS65 with the GM501, it ends up being a bit more appealing because of the slightly lower price, which works in its favour.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7 8750H | PLATFORM: HM370 | RAM: 16 GB 2666 MHz | SCREEN SIZE: 15.6-inches | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 1920x1080 | GPU: GTX 1070 8 GB GDDR5X | SSD: Samsung SM961 1 TB NVMe | BATTERY: 55 Whr | AC ADAPTER: 230 W | WEIGHT: 2.2 kg

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